Wapic Insurance holds private screening for 93 Days

OBINNA EMELIKE

Wapic Insurance plc sponsored the production of the movie 93 Days, a media- based initiative, centred on the true-life story of the outbreak of the highly dreaded Ebola Virus and its eradication in Nigeria, in line with its corporate social responsibility focus on health.

The company is set to hold a private screening of the movie on September 9, at the Genesis Deluxe Cinemas, Lekki. The event, which is already generating interest, is expected to witness a high turnout of the cast of the movie, top celebrities, customers and staff of the firm.

According to Steve Gukas, co-producer of the movie, "93 Days is a movie that celebrates the act of doing what is right, selfless service and making a difference in the world."

By associating with the movie production and screening, Wapic Insurance is making a bold statement about its values and virtues as well as its commitment to partnerships that promote social wellbeing and sustainability in health care. The event would also offer an opportunity for Wapic to appreciate its customers for their support towards the growth of the Company.

The movie 93 Days is based on true events in relation to the sacrifices made by men and women who risked their lives to save Nigeria from the spread of the Ebola Virus and in honour of a heroine Dr. Ameyo Stella Adadevoh, who played a significant role to eradicate the virus. It is a story of how ordinary citizens through resilience and sacrifices gave their all to promote the common good.

Wapic Insurance is a West African multi-line insurance company providing solutions covering life, general and special risks. Established in 1958 and listed on the Nigerian Stock Exchange since 1978, Wapic's mission is to transform into a diversified financial services institution, delivering value in a sustainable manner to its customers and stakeholders while playing a lead role in the transformation of the industry.

With headquarters in Lagos, Nigeria, Wapic is organised into two core business segments, General and Life Insurance. The Company has two wholly owned subsidiaries, Wapic Life Assurance Limited and Wapic Insurance (Ghana) Limited as well as an associated company, Coronation Merchant Bank Limited.

Through a diverse portfolio of products and a commitment to providing the best customer experience possible, Wapic, with an AM Best Financial Strength rating of "B-" and an Issuer Credit rating of 'bb-", has significantly enhanced its underwriting capacity placing it among the top five insurance companies in Nigeria by solvency and capital.

L-R: Pelu Awofeso, founder/CEO, Travel Next Door; Uche Akolisa, 1st place winner, writing; Jitesh Pamnani, GM, Lucky Fibres, and Neec Nonso, 1st place winner photography at the prize presentation to winners of 'My Nigeria Travel Story' contest, sponsored by the Nobel Carpets and Rugs in Lagos.

Weco Systems attains certification status in NetApp partner programme

Weco Systems International Limited, a systems integration firm known for delivery of innovative technology solutions, has achieved platinum certified status in the NetApp Partner Programme.

NetApp is a leader in unified storage and data management solutions for today's data-intensive enterprise. As a NetApp Platinum Partner, Weco Systems has successfully gone through and completed rigorous training, testing and validations required for NetApp solution sales, pre-sales and deployment personnel.

While presenting the letter on the status upgrade, Joel Ryser, regional sales manager, East and West Africa, NetApp, said: "Weco Systems has been a trusted and committed NetApp partner for over five years. We are pleased to honour this commitment with a promotion to Platinum Partner status. Building on this momentum, we look forward to more successful joint business in the region."

In response to the status conferred on Weco Systems, Nnamdi Onyebuchi, the executive director, technology and operations, described the status as a further endorsement of Weco's commitment to continuous investment in innovation and skills that will ensure acceleration of favourable business outcomes to our esteemed customers through the optimisation of their IT infrastructure investments and delivery of new capabilities.

"We believe the experience and skills garnered in the process of achieving this status will position us to further deepen our data centre and cloud solution and services practice in Nigeria and its environs," Onyebuchi said.

"The achievement of this unique milestone symbolises the deepening and taking to the next level the strategic partnership between Weco Systems and NetApp and this is quite an important step for us," according to Obinna Ekwonwa, CEO, Weco Systems.

"This also goes on to further consolidate our capabilities and value proposition in the Enterprise Data Centre solutions market segment of our business as we are better positioned to support organisations and their businesses going forward. "We also believe that Platinum partnership with NetApp is a recognition and validation for our sustained drive in building this area of expertise, and at the same time an encouragement to sustain our commitment towards our business philosophy, which is – 'Technology aligned with business outcomes," he said.

SA Insurance gets BBB rating from global rating agency

MODESTUS ANAESORONYE

Standard Alliance Insurance Plc which recently got its shareholders' nod to merge with its life sister company, Standard Alliance Life Assurance Limited, for greater strength and a more superior bottom-line performance has been rated 'BBB' by Global Credit Rating, a South African-based rating body, in recognition of its consistent claims paying ability.

Passing a remark in its conclusive report released during the month of August, the rating body observed that the general business underwriting company's "gross claims declined 17 percent during the year to N887 million with an improvement noted across most classes of business barring fire and marine line," stating that "while an 11 percent rise in net claims is anticipated during the year, the net incurred loss ratio is expected to contract to 21 percent in 2016 financial year based on the expected growth in premiums."

While noting that the company was stable in its rating outlook, the rating body further observed that "shareholders' funds rose by 28 percent to N4.2 billion at 2015 financial year end on the back of internal capital generation," stating further that "in conjunction with a substantial reduction in retained premium volumes, this led to an improvement in risk adjusted capitalisation with the ratio of shareholders' funds to net earned premium improving to 172 percent in 2015 from 86 percent in 2014 financial year end."

The report noted that the company's statutory solvency regained compliance at 2015 financial year end with admissible asset coverage of liabilities, stating that "going forward, risk adjusted capital adequacy is expected to remain at an adequate level."

While observing that the company's focus remains on penetrating the retail market with management confirming new products, which were in the offering to further drive the retail growth, the report stated that SA Insurance's realised investment income rebounded in 2015 following the share of profit of an associate company during the year.

According to the report, "the insurer's share of profit or loss has been included in the investment income calculation over the period. Total interest, rental and dividend income lowered to N197 million in 2015, underpinned by reductions in interest income. Overall, operating margin equated to 3 percent in 2015," stating that "similarly, investment yield registered an improvement to 8 percent from a negative 6 percent previously."

CBN trains 6, 532 unemployed youths on vocational skills

Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN) Entrepreneurship Development Centre (EDC) in Borno says it has trained 6, 532 youths from the North East on different vocational skills.

Abubakar Gusau, the managing director of the centre made this known while speaking at a meeting of the Technical Advisory Committee (TAC) of the centre in Maiduguri.

According to him, the training is part of efforts to tackle unemployment and accelerate economic development in the area.

``The EDC northeast zone Maiduguri is a CBN initiative which was established in 2013 to cater for the entire sub-region.

``Precisely, it was flagged-off in Maiduguri on Feb. 15, 2013 by the then CBN Governor Alhaji Lamido Sanusi.

``It is a tripartite agreement signed between the CBN, the Borno State Government and the A.I. Development Services Ltd as the implementing agency of the programme.

``The mandate is to train 10,000 participants in the northeast within the span of five year period of the programme."

He said that the objective was to develop the entrepreneurship spirit among the direct beneficiaries of the programme.

Gusau said that the programme was also aimed at equipping the youth with insights, tools, techniques and framework for functional areas of business enterprise including planning, production, marketing, personnel and finance.

``It is also to develop the skills of direct beneficiaries to successfully start, manage, diversify and expand business enterprises.

``Additionally, it is to link the graduates of the programme to financial institutions and other sources of funds for the start-up capital.

``In line with the forgoing objectives of the EDC programme, the centre in its three and a half years of operations had so far trained 6,532 participants," he said.

Gusau stated that the centre had also certified 4,485 business plans during the period.

``It has also certified 4,485 business plans that can be presented to banks and other financial institutions for loans consideration," Gusau said.